VIT Bhopal University

VITyarthi E-Learning Platform

CSE0001 – Digital Literacy

Project Assignment Report

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Introduction

This project report documents my work as part of the CSE0001 – Digital Literacy course at VIT Bhopal University. The assignment placed me in the role of a Student Digital Ambassador — someone responsible for helping batchmates navigate the digital world safely, professionally, and effectively.

Over the course of five structured tasks, I explored key areas of digital literacy: creating awareness content through an infographic, building a professional digital presence across multiple platforms, practising on coding and collaboration tools, developing professional communication skills through email writing, and researching cybercrime to understand how to stay safe online.

All five tasks were completed and organised within a single GitHub repository, which itself served as a practical exercise in version control and digital organisation. This report summarises each task — what I did, which tools I used, what I observed, and what I learned. The project has given me a strong foundation in the digital skills that are essential for any engineering student entering a technology-driven world.

Task 1 – Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

Module 1 | Marks: 20

For this task, I created a one-page digital literacy awareness infographic aimed at helping my batchmates understand what digital literacy is and why it is important in today's world. I chose Canva as my design tool because it is free, browser-based, and offers a wide variety of templates that made it easy to create a visually appealing layout without any prior graphic design experience.

My infographic covered three core topics: what digital literacy means and why it matters for students, useful digital tools for academic and professional use (such as Google Workspace, GitHub, and Canva itself), and safe internet practices including strong passwords, two-factor authentication, and recognising phishing attempts. I used a clean colour palette with clear headings, icons, and short text blocks to keep it easy to read at a glance.

The most interesting aspect of this task was realising how much I already use digital tools without thinking about them critically. Deciding which information was most important and how to present it visually in limited space was the most challenging part — I had to simplify complex ideas into short, clear points. This exercise made me appreciate how powerful well-designed visual communication can be, especially when reaching an audience that may not have prior knowledge of a topic.

Task 2 – Student Digital Portfolio

Module 2 | Marks: 20

For this task, I set up accounts on three major professional platforms: GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle. Each of these serves a distinct purpose in a student's academic and career journey, and together they form the foundation of a strong digital presence.

GitHub is a version control and code hosting platform widely used by developers and students. I created a profile README — a special repository named after my username — which includes my name, branch, year, and a brief note about what I hope to learn during my B.Tech programme. This README acts as my public introduction to the developer community. LinkedIn is the world's largest professional networking platform. I filled in my Education section with my current degree (B.Tech – CSE AIML), institution (VIT Bhopal University), and expected graduation year. LinkedIn will be essential when I begin applying for internships and jobs. Kaggle is a platform dedicated to data science and machine learning — particularly relevant given my AIML specialisation. I created an account to access datasets, participate in competitions, and learn from community notebooks.

Over the next four years, I plan to use GitHub to host all my academic projects and build a visible coding portfolio, LinkedIn to network with professionals and apply for internships, and Kaggle to practise machine learning by participating in beginner competitions and following data science discussions. Setting up these profiles now — even minimally — ensures I am building my digital presence early rather than scrambling before placement season.

Task 3 – Coding & Collaboration Platforms

Module 3 | Marks: 20

This task had two parts. For Part A, I created an account on HackerRank and completed a beginner-level challenge. I chose the 'Solve Me First' problem, which involves reading two integers and printing their sum. Although the problem itself is straightforward, the experience of navigating a competitive programming interface — reading problem statements, writing code in the browser editor, and submitting for automated evaluation — was genuinely useful. I also completed the Python Introduction challenge to earn the Python (Basic) skill badge.

For Part B, I built a five-question Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz using Google Forms. The quiz included two multiple choice questions (covering topics like safe password practices and identifying phishing emails), two true/false questions, and one short answer question asking students to name one digital tool they use regularly for studying. The linked Google Sheet automatically records every response, making it easy to analyse results. I shared the form link in my GitHub README so batchmates can actually take the quiz.

These tools will be highly useful during my academic journey. HackerRank helps me practise problem-solving skills in a structured, evaluated environment — important for technical interviews and competitive exams. Google Forms and Google Sheets together are powerful for collecting and analysing data, which will be directly applicable in research projects, surveys, and group work. This task showed me that collaboration tools are just as important as technical coding skills.

Task 4 – Professional Email & Etiquette Guide

Module 4 | Marks: 20

This task required me to write two professional emails and create a social media checklist. Writing formal emails is a skill I had not consciously practised before, and this task made me realise how much tone, structure, and word choice matter in professional communication.

The first email was from a student to a professor requesting a deadline extension — a situation many students face but often handle poorly by sending informal, last-minute messages. I focused on being polite, taking responsibility, and making a specific, reasonable request. The second email was to an internship coordinator expressing interest in a summer internship opportunity. Here, I had to introduce myself briefly and professionally, mention relevant skills, and close with a clear call to action — all without being overly long or casual.

For the social media checklist, I created a table of five Do's (such as keeping profiles professional, using privacy settings wisely, and thinking before posting) and five Don'ts (such as sharing personal contact information publicly, engaging in online arguments, or posting content that could embarrass you professionally). The communication scenario I reflected on was a case where a student posted a frustrated comment about their college on a public social media account, which was later seen by a recruiter during a placement process and led to rejection. The lesson is clear: once something is posted online, it is very difficult to erase — and the professional world is always watching.

Task 5 – Cybercrime Awareness: Cyberbullying

Module 5 | Marks: 20

For this task, I chose Cyberbullying as my cybercrime topic. I selected this because it is one of the most common online threats faced by students and young people, yet it is often not recognised as a serious crime.

My case study described a realistic scenario in which a first-year college student was repeatedly targeted by anonymous accounts on social media — receiving hostile messages, being excluded from group chats, and having embarrassing photos shared without consent. The case study outlined how cyberbullying typically begins (often after a real-life conflict or out of jealousy), how it escalates when the victim does not respond or block, who is typically targeted (younger students, newcomers, and those perceived as different), and what the consequences are — ranging from anxiety and depression to academic decline and, in severe cases, self-harm.

What surprised me most while researching this topic was how underreported cyberbullying is in India. Many victims feel ashamed or fear that adults will overreact, so they suffer in silence. I also learned about the National Cyber Crime Portal (cybercrime.gov.in) and Helpline 1930, which are government resources specifically for reporting such incidents — resources I was not aware of before this task. One habit I will personally change as a result of this research is to think carefully before sharing or forwarding any content about another person online, even as a joke, because intent and impact are two very different things.

Conclusion

This project has been a comprehensive introduction to the world of digital literacy. Across five tasks, I moved from creating visual content to building a professional online identity, practising technical skills, writing formal communication, and understanding online threats. The most valuable takeaway is that digital literacy is not just about knowing how to use tools — it is about using them responsibly, professionally, and safely. As a first-year B.Tech student specialising in AIML, these skills are not optional extras; they are the foundation on which my entire academic and professional career will be built. My GitHub repository now stands as a living record of this learning, one that I intend to keep growing throughout my degree.

References

- Canva – Free Design Tool: https://www.canva.com
- GitHub – Code Hosting and Version Control: https://github.com
- LinkedIn – Professional Networking Platform: https://www.linkedin.com
- Kaggle – Data Science and ML Platform: https://www.kaggle.com
- HackerRank – Coding Practice Platform: https://www.hackerrank.com
- Google Forms – Survey and Quiz Tool: https://forms.google.com
- National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal: https://cybercrime.gov.in
- Cyber Crime Helpline: 1930 (Government of India, 24x7)
- VIT Bhopal University – VITyarthi E-Learning Platform: https://vityarthi.vitbhopal.ac.in